

# FUTURE FORWARD

Here are those who missed out as they have not yet completed a year in office; they'll be strong contenders in 2024

## The Transporter

**AS THE FIRST** woman Chairperson and Chief Executive Officer of the Railway Board, Jaya Varma Sinha, 60, has literally stormed a till now male-dominated bastion. But this is nothing new for her. She was also the first woman to be appointed as the Principal Chief Operations Manager of South Eastern Railway.

Sinha, an Indian Railway Traffic Service official, has vast experience in various verticals such as operations, commercial, IT and vigilance in her nearly 35-year career, and she is held in high esteem by her peers and in industry circles.

Given her exceptional track record, Sinha, who was due to retire in September 2023, has

been given a one-year extension. Under her leadership, the Railways, which logged a record revenue of ₹2.4 lakh crore in 2022-23, is seen to have exceeded ₹1.5 lakh crore by November-end this year. However, maintaining this robust growth in revenue is a challenge.

She has been working round the clock on various initiatives, including the modernisation of rail infrastructure, roll-out of more Vande Bharat trains as well as pushing up freight revenues that had been languishing in recent years. Completing the Dedicated Freight Corridor (DFC) initiative as well as the bullet train project are also top priorities for the Railways, under Sinha, as it tries to upgrade its infrastructure and get future ready.

However, managing one of the largest railway networks in the world is not easy. Safety concerns have long marred the national transporter's reputation, and they've come back into the spotlight because of recent mishaps. For Sinha, improving the Indian Railways' track record on this front will be a key priority and an achievement. **BT**

— BY **SURABHI**



**MANSI MADAN TRIPATHY**

51, Country Chair, Shell India

## SHELL LIFE

**It's been a little over two months since Mansi Madan Tripathy assumed the role of Country Chair of Shell India, succeeding Nitin Prasad, who had held the position since 2016. An alumna of the National Institute of Technology, Kurukshetra, and the S.P. Jain Institute of Management and Research, with experience of working on diverse product categories, multifunctional and multicultural teams, channels and business models, Tripathy, in her latest role, will oversee the Shell Group of companies, which she joined in 2012, in India. This will be in addition to her role as VP, Shell Lubricants for Asia-Pacific. Her new role will also see her relocate from Singapore to Delhi. This diverse, international exposure will, no doubt, come in handy in her new role. **BT****

— BY **ASHISH RUKHAIYAR**

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**JAYA VARMA SINHA**

60, Chairperson and CEO, Railway Board